



PAPER

A



2018 ENGLISH

**DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET
UNTIL INSTRUCTED.**

45 QUESTIONS

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

STUDENT'S NAME:

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a pencil. Do **NOT** use a coloured pencil or a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.

Your score will be the number of correct answers.

Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **45 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–45).

Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.

On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other. Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

ICAS

The Earl of Sandwich

The Earl of Sandwich looked at his cards and frowned. His stomach rumbled but he didn't want to stop playing. The Earl clicked his fingers. The smell of peas, celery and onion came wafting in. His servant appeared carrying pea soup. He slurped the soup while holding his cards. The soup sloshed onto the cards. The Earl frowned and clicked his fingers.



The smell of roasted meat rushed into the room. His servant appeared carrying cut up chicken. The Earl nibbled the meat whilst holding his cards. The meat left a greasy smear on the cards. The Earl frowned and clicked his fingers.



The smell of warm toast filled the room. His servant appeared carrying salted meat between two slices of toasted bread. The Earl crunched into the toast and meat. He looked at his cards and nodded, then beamed. His playing partner laughed and said, 'I'll have what Sandwich is having.' And so the sandwich was born.



1. How did the Earl of Sandwich know that it was time to eat?
 - (A) His playing partner said so.
 - (B) He looked at the clock on the wall.
 - (C) His stomach started to rumble.
 - (D) His servant entered the room with food.

2. When the Earl of Sandwich clicked his fingers, it was a signal that
 - (A) he would like his food taken away.
 - (B) his servant should bring him some food.
 - (C) a new card game was about to begin.
 - (D) his servant should bring a new set of cards.

3. Why was the Earl of Sandwich unhappy with the first two food choices?
 - (A) They were messy.
 - (B) They smelled bad.
 - (C) They were cold.
 - (D) They tasted bad.

4. When beginning sounds are repeated in a group of words, it is called alliteration. For example, 'dogs dig during the day'.
Which of these is another example of alliteration?
 - (A) 'The Earl of Sandwich'
 - (B) 'His servant appeared carrying pea soup.'
 - (C) 'The smell of roasted meat rushed into the room.'
 - (D) 'The Earl crunched into the toast and meat.'

5. In the third paragraph when the Earl of Sandwich 'beamed', what was he doing?
 - (A) winning
 - (B) agreeing
 - (C) nodding
 - (D) smiling

6. In the text, when 'Sandwich' is written with a capital letter it shows that
 - (A) it is a joke.
 - (B) it is the name of a person.
 - (C) it is the start of a sentence.
 - (D) it is a type of food.

7. 'And so the sandwich was born.' (paragraph 3)
Which word would best replace 'born' in the sentence?
 - (A) found
 - (B) saved
 - (C) invented
 - (D) eaten

8. Which problem did the Earl of Sandwich find a solution for?
 - (A) how to decide what type of food to serve
 - (B) how to eat with one hand while keeping clean
 - (C) how to be successful at card games
 - (D) how to feed his guests quickly



Maratus jactatus



Maratus sceletus

Weird and wacky spiders

Some Australian spiders have terrifying names. Funnel-web and redback are names that scream danger. Even the helpful huntsman spider sounds like it could be out to get you. But not all spiders have scary names. How would you feel about meeting a spider called sparklemuffin?

'Sparklemuffin is a beautiful peacock spider, *Maratus jactatus*, with a lovely blue and orange body,' says spider expert Robert Whyte. And it's not the only spider with a funny name. 'Another peacock spider was nicknamed skeletonus, and it actually looks like a skeleton costume.'

These strange names might seem silly, but they can actually be useful. 'Odd names help you remember spiders,' says Robert. 'The dewdrop spider, which lives in the webs of golden orb-weavers and steals their food, actually looks like a dew drop sparkling in the sunshine.'

These fun common names are only half of the spider story. Known spiders, just like all other described species, also have a scientific name. For example, the name *Maratus jactatus*, is the scientific name for sparklemuffin. Though scientific names might be more serious than common names, that doesn't stop scientists from having a little fun now and then.

'A lot of spiders are named after people,' says Robert. Someone named a jumping spider after Robert, *Cytaea whytei*. Sadly for him, it was found to be an already-named spider *Cytaea haemastica*, so scientists use the older name instead. As a consolation, Robert still has the species *Maddisonia whytei* named in his honour.

If you've discovered a new species of spider, what naming advice does Robert have? 'There are rules about naming, which stop you using offensive names, but you can use cute names like abracadabrella, which is a type of jumping spider. These species mimic a fly with two large blobs like fly eyes on their rear end.' The scientist who named the spider, Marek Zabka, must have thought this was pretty magical. Naming is a science with a dash of art and imagination!

9. In the first paragraph, why does the writer use the word 'scream'?
- (A) to add emphasis
 - (B) to create confusion
 - (C) to give a warning
 - (D) to make a threat
10. How does the writer get readers' attention in the first paragraph?
- (A) by providing a story about spiders to make a personal connection
 - (B) by contrasting frightening spider names with amusing ones
 - (C) by testing readers' knowledge of both familiar and lesser known spiders
 - (D) by telling readers how they should feel about spiders
11. According to the text, scientific names are
- (A) more serious than common names.
 - (B) much longer than common names.
 - (C) named after where the spider was discovered.
 - (D) artistic and imaginative.
12. Which word from the text describes the same feeling as 'terrifying'?
- (A) 'danger'
 - (B) 'scary'
 - (C) 'strange'
 - (D) 'offensive'
13. *Cytaea whytei* was not accepted as a name because
- (A) the name was too hard to say.
 - (B) the species only had a common name.
 - (C) the species already had a scientific name.
 - (D) the scientist already had a species named after him.
14. What does the word 'consolation' mean?
- (A) favour
 - (B) relief
 - (C) surprise
 - (D) comfort
15. Which of these words underlined in the last paragraph is used as a verb?
- (A) 'naming'
 - (B) 'jumping'
 - (C) 'mimic'
 - (D) 'dash'

The Triantiwontigongolope

- There's a very funny insect that you do not often spy,
And it isn't quite a spider, and it isn't quite a fly;
It is something like a beetle, and a little like a bee,
But nothing like a woolly grub that climbs upon a tree.
5 Its name is quite a hard one, but you'll learn it soon, I hope.
So, try:

Tri-

Tri-anti-wonti

Triantiwontigongolope.

- 10 It lives on weeds and wattle-gum, and has a funny face;
Its appetite is hearty, and its manners a disgrace.
When first you come upon it, it will give you quite a scare,
But when you look for it again you find it isn't there.
And unless you call it softly it will stay away and mope.

- 15 So, try:

Tri-

Tri-anti-wonti

Triantiwontigongolope.

- It trembles if you tickle it or tread upon its toes;
20 It is not an early riser, but it has a snubbish nose.
If you sneer at it or scold it, it will scuttle off in shame,
But it purrs and purrs quite proudly if you call it by its name,
And offer it some sandwiches of sealing-wax and soap.

- So, try:

- 25 Tri-

Tri-anti-wonti

Triantiwontigongolope.

- But of course you haven't seen it; and I truthfully confess
That I haven't seen it either, and I don't know its address.
30 For there isn't such an insect, though there really might have been
If the trees and grass were purple, and the sky was bottle-green.
It's just a little joke of mine, which you'll forgive, I hope.

- Oh, try:

Try!

- 35 Tri-anti-wonti

Triantiwontigongolope.

C.J. Dennis

16. When the poet says 'you do not often spy' the creature, he wants readers to believe that
- (A) it is not hunted anymore.
 - (B) it is not very interesting.
 - (C) it is not very common.
 - (D) it is not good at hiding.
17. The purpose of the first three stanzas is
- (A) to explain how the creature is similar to other insects.
 - (B) to describe the creature for those who have not seen it.
 - (C) to warn readers to be careful of the creature.
 - (D) to outline the best way to track down the creature.
18. In line 14 the word 'mope' means
- (A) sulk.
 - (B) shiver.
 - (C) sleep.
 - (D) disappear.
19. The poet says that the creature makes a _____ sound.
- (A) scratching
 - (B) buzzing
 - (C) purring
 - (D) chomping
20. 'If the trees and grass were purple, and the sky was bottle-green'
Why is this line included in the poem?
- (A) to indicate the type of environment the creature prefers
 - (B) to point out the place where the creature hides
 - (C) to describe a time when the creature was alive
 - (D) to show that the creature is imaginary
21. At the end of the poem, the poet apologises for
- (A) not using an easier name for the creature.
 - (B) trying to trick the reader into believing that the creature exists.
 - (C) not being able to describe the creature more accurately.
 - (D) asking the reader to search for the creature.
22. 'So, try:
Tri-
Tri-anti-wonti
Triantiwontigongolope.'
- The last four lines of each stanza are set out in this way because
- (A) it helps the reader say the creature's name.
 - (B) the creature's name is too long to fit on one line.
 - (C) it separates the three words that make up the creature's name.
 - (D) the creature's name is also the title of the poem.

What's the tallest mountain in the world?

That's a pretty silly question, right?

Everybody knows that Mount Everest is the world's tallest mountain. In fact we all know a lot about Mount Everest for that very reason. Most people know that it is in the Himalayas and that in 1953 Sir Edmund Hillary and Sherpa Tenzing Norgay were the first people to climb to the top. Climbing it is still the ultimate dream of mountaineers and adventurers all over the world. However, only a fraction of those people will ever make it to the top.

Expeditions to Everest take huge amounts of training, planning, time and money, as well as serious mountaineering expertise. It can take about two months to complete the climb as climbers have to adjust to the ever-reducing amount of oxygen as they go higher. In addition, the weather conditions are extreme and changeable. These conditions make the climb one of the most challenging possible.

Imagine if just anybody could hike up the tallest mountain in the world and be back down again in time for dinner, with no special equipment or training needed. Well, perhaps they can, because it seems that when it comes to measuring mountains the playing field is far from level. Traditionally, mountains have been measured from sea level to peak. So Everest, with a peak 8848 metres above sea level, is undoubtedly the tallest.

But what about mountains that do not begin at sea level?

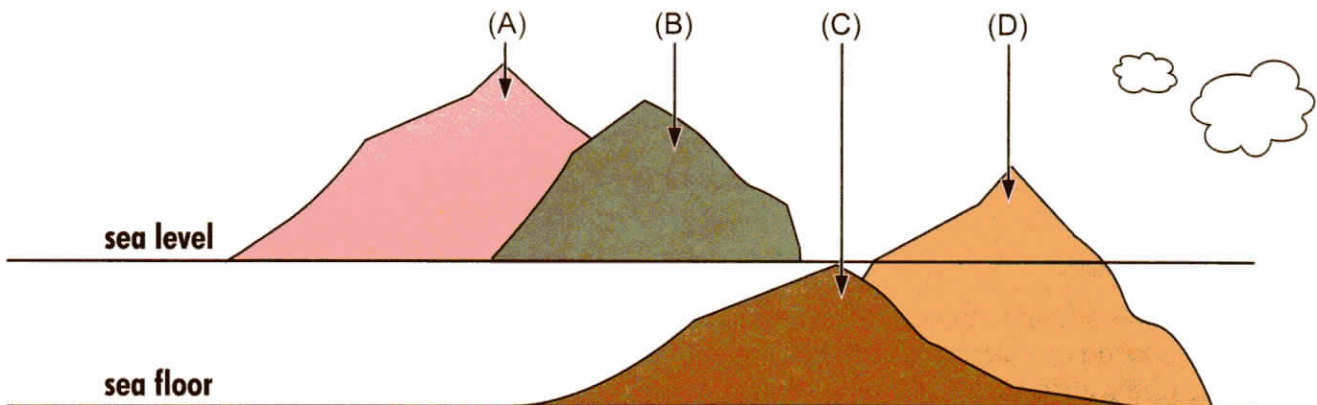
If we were to measure mountains from top to bottom, then the tallest mountain on Earth would be Mauna Kea on the island of Hawaii. Measured from sea level, Mauna Kea is only 4207 metres tall; that's less than half the height of Mount Everest. BUT the base of Mauna Kea lies deep down on the floor of the Pacific Ocean and that's a really long way down! From top to bottom, Mauna Kea stands a huge 10 210 metres tall.

Preparing for *that* expedition is a lot more civilised. How about driving to the Visitor Centre? It sits at the 2800-metre mark. From there you could hike—it's an 8-hour trip there and back—to the summit. Or, if you're pushed for time, why not drive all the way to the top? Just remember that starting from the bottom is not a great idea!



23. Who does the word 'we' refer to in the second paragraph?
- (A) 'Everybody'
 - (B) 'Most people'
 - (C) 'the first people'
 - (D) 'mountaineers and adventurers all over the world'
24. In the third paragraph, what does 'expertise' refer to?
- (A) being highly motivated
 - (B) having considerable skill and knowledge
 - (C) being fully prepared
 - (D) having great physical strength and courage
25. What is meant by the quotation, 'when it comes to measuring mountains the playing field is far from level' (paragraph 4)?
- (A) It is not possible to measure mountains that are not side by side.
 - (B) The mountains have not been measured accurately.
 - (C) It is not useful to compare the heights of mountains.
 - (D) There is more than one way to describe how tall a mountain is.

26. In this diagram of four mountains, which one is Mount Everest?



27. Where is the Mauna Kea Visitor Centre situated?
- (A) 4207 metres from the base of the mountain
 - (B) at the summit
 - (C) 2800 metres above sea level
 - (D) at sea level
28. 'Just remember that starting from the bottom is not a great idea!' (paragraph 7)
Why would it be a bad idea to start climbing Mauna Kea from the bottom?
- (A) The bottom is thousands of metres below the ocean's surface.
 - (B) It would take a very long time to get to the summit.
 - (C) The altitude would be dangerous even for experienced climbers.
 - (D) The bottom is thousands of metres below the ground.
29. In the last paragraph, the writer encourages readers to climb Mauna Kea by emphasising
- (A) how tall it is compared to Mount Everest.
 - (B) how easy it is to reach the summit compared to Mount Everest.
 - (C) how few people have climbed it compared to Mount Everest.
 - (D) how difficult the climb is compared to Mount Everest.

The rescue

‘ZARA!’

Zara’s eyes opened wide. She stared up through the dark geometric leaves in the branches of the tree above her. The sky was pale blue and shiny as silk. They’d been swimming and then sun tanning, and she had dozed off in the warm afternoon air. Now someone was pulling her roughly by the shoulder.

‘Zara! Get up!’

It was Mel. Her cheeks were burnt bright red. She must have lost her hat, thought Zara sleepily. They were both barefoot and in their swimsuits.

‘What is it?’ she yawned.

‘It’s Ethan,’ said Mel.

She gripped onto Zara urgently with both hands, pulling her to her feet.

‘What about him?’

‘He’s stuck down the cliff!’ said Mel. Her voice trembled. ‘He must have gone exploring while we were sleeping. Quick, I’ll show you!’

Mel raced off and Zara followed. They ran to where the land finished and then broke away into a sandstone wall above the ocean. When they were close to the edge, they dropped to their knees, slithered forward across the strands of dry yellow grass, and peered over.

‘There he is!’

Ethan was sitting with his arms wrapped round his knees on an outcrop of rock halfway down the face of the cliff. He looked very small and pale.

‘Ethan!’ Zara called out.

He couldn’t hear her, so she raised her voice above the sound of the crashing surf.



‘Ethan!’

His head jerked upwards. When he saw the heads of his two older sisters, poking over the edge of the cliff, he knew this disastrous ordeal was about to come to an end.

‘Don’t move! Stay right there!’ shouted Zara. ‘I’ll come down and help you up.’

‘It’s too steep,’ murmured Mel, tensely.

The cliff was sheer. But there were footholds in the sandstone, and plenty of hardy little bushes growing out of various crevices to hang onto.

‘I can do it,’ Zara said stoutly.

She turned herself backwards as though climbing down a ladder. Within moments, she had reached him. She grinned. He smiled back sheepishly.

‘See,’ she said. ‘That wasn’t so bad. Now, you go back up first and I’ll follow you.’



30. The writer most likely uses capital letters in the first line of the story to
- (A) show the volume of a spoken word.
 - (B) create a sub-heading for the text.
 - (C) spell out a spoken word.
 - (D) introduce a character.
31. In the second paragraph, the writer uses the words 'shiny as silk' to show that
- (A) the sun felt warm on Zara's skin.
 - (B) the clouds were soft and white.
 - (C) the light was gleaming brightly.
 - (D) the sky looked like Zara's swimsuit.
32. Why did the girls drop to their knees and slither forward when they were close to the edge?
- (A) They were trying to be careful.
 - (B) They were sneaking up on Ethan.
 - (C) They were listening closely for Ethan's call.
 - (D) They were looking for things they could use in the rescue.
33. According to the text, Zara had to raise her voice because
- (A) she was panicking.
 - (B) Ethan was still missing.
 - (C) the waves were too noisy.
 - (D) the cliff was too steep.
34. Which underlined word from the text is used as an adjective?
- (A) 'peered'
 - (B) 'crashing'
 - (C) 'jerked'
 - (D) 'poking'
35. How did Ethan feel when he spotted his sisters?
- (A) dreadful
 - (B) resentful
 - (C) relieved
 - (D) surprised
36. Why did Ethan become stuck?
- (A) He had hurt his knees.
 - (B) He didn't know how to climb.
 - (C) The bushes were slippery.
 - (D) The cliff was too sheer.
37. Near the end of the story Ethan smiled at Zara 'sheepishly' because
- (A) he saw how annoyed she had been.
 - (B) he felt foolish being stuck down the cliff.
 - (C) he was glad to have had an adventure.
 - (D) he preferred to find his own way back up the cliff.
38. Based on the information in the text, how could Ethan best be described?
- (A) a curious boy who overestimated his ability
 - (B) a brave boy who loved a dangerous challenge
 - (C) a young boy who didn't care about his family
 - (D) a lively boy who ignored the advice of others

An expanding, exploding universe

It's summer! Summer means lazy days, long afternoons, ice-creams and hanging with friends. Summer also means it's time to head to your local cinema, purchase some popcorn and relax with the latest comic book superhero movie.

Reduction Day: The Rise of Veydu will keep you and your friends entertained. It's the fifth movie that has been made using the characters from *The Last Legion* comic book series. The movies have been combining and recombining the four members of the Legion: Radara, Quark, Baby Mammoth and Inferno, since the beginning of the series. Other characters and stories have been slowly introduced from the huge collection of plots built up over 70 years of comic-book publishing.

The storyline of *Reduction Day* is totally unbelievable, but not bad. Fifty million years ago, aliens hid one of their children in Antarctica so that they could observe and monitor the rise of human civilisation. When global warming finally cracks the ice shelf, Veydu the alien emerges, fully grown and furious at the environmental catastrophe that has released her.

Veydu begins to blow up the great cities of the world in order to reduce pollution and 're-green' the planet. Familiar skylines become rubble in jaw-dropping explosion sequences. The Last Legion bravely defend Earth's cities, cars and factories, and the benefits they have brought to modern life, but they also admit to themselves (privately) that the planet is not in great shape. There's more than enough tension in this global-warming-meets-superhero mix to keep our interest. This genre's success relies on how well it can balance sincerity with humour, and the dialogue in *Reduction Day* will meet the needs of both parents and children. We all need to be able to giggle when characters say ridiculous things with perfectly straight faces.

The four main actors know their superhero characters well by now, but Val Starkey's performance as Quark is a particular standout. Quark is still the wisecracking atom bender we love to be annoyed by, but there's also a new depth and compassion to his performance. It feels like the movie is signalling a new direction for this character.

It's the holidays and there has never been a better time to be a Last Legion fan.

39. In the title, the word 'exploding' refers to
- (A) the announcement of a new movie.
 - (B) the stress of global warming.
 - (C) the Earth's growing population.
 - (D) the cities being destroyed.
40. *The Last Legion* members defend modern civilisation _____ understanding the environmental destruction that civilisation can cause.
- Which word correctly joins the two clauses in this description of the Last Legion?
- (A) although
 - (B) however
 - (C) consequently
 - (D) despite
41. The phrase 'with perfectly straight faces' (paragraph 4) means the actors
- (A) perform without reacting to the dialogue.
 - (B) have very smooth facial features.
 - (C) deliver their lines clearly and sincerely.
 - (D) are well-known comedians.
42. Which of the underlined words is a verb?
- (A) 'hanging'
 - (B) 'publishing'
 - (C) 'jaw-dropping'
 - (D) 'wisecracking'
43. In the final sentence of the text the reviewer concludes that
- (A) the Last Legion fan club is a good holiday activity.
 - (B) the holidays are the only time the movie is showing.
 - (C) the movie is worth seeing in the holidays.
 - (D) the movie can only be enjoyed by Last Legion fans.
44. The overall tone of the review is
- (A) humorous.
 - (B) mocking.
 - (C) arrogant.
 - (D) complimentary.
45. Which of the following would **NOT** be included in the advertising trailer for *Reduction Day: The Rise of Veydu*?
- (A) genre
 - (B) setting
 - (C) characters
 - (D) plot twists

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SOURCES

Page 4 "Weird and wacky spiders" by Double Helix www.doublehelix.csiro.au.
Maratus jactatus and *Maratus sceletus* photography by Jurgen Otto.

Page 6 "Triantiwontigongolope" poem by C.J. Dennis, 1921.

THE FOLLOWING YEAR LEVELS SHOULD SIT THIS PAPER:

Australia	Year 3
Brunei	Primary 3
Egypt	Year 3
Hong Kong	Primary 3
Indian Subcontinent¹	Class 3
Indonesia	Year 4
Malaysia	Standard 3
Middle East²	Class 3
New Zealand/Pacific³	Year 4
Singapore	Primary 2
Southern Africa⁴	Grade 3

¹ Indian Subcontinent Region: India, Sri Lanka, Nepal, Bhutan and Bangladesh.
² Middle East Region: United Arab Emirates, Qatar, Kuwait, Saudi Arabia, Bahrain, Oman, Turkey, Lebanon, Tunisia, Morocco, Libya, Algeria, Jordan and Pakistan.

³ Pacific Region: Vanuatu, Papua New Guinea and Fiji.

⁴ Southern Africa Region: South Africa, Botswana, Lesotho, Swaziland, Zimbabwe and Namibia.

PAPER

A



UNSW Global

ANALYSIS BY QUESTION

The following table shows the questions you answered correctly ☒ and shades the questions that you answered incorrectly ☐. The questions are ranked from hardest at the top to easiest at the bottom.

		Question number	Correct answer
Difficult Questions	Question content	Area assessed	
	Identify a verb in an information text	Syntax	15 C
	Interpret the meaning of a word in an information text: consolation	Vocabulary	14 D
	Identify the correct conjunction in a movie review	Syntax	40 D
	Explain a writer's word choice in an information text	Writer's craft	9 A
	Infer the meaning of a word in a movie review: exploding	Text comprehension	39 D
	Explain the conclusion of a movie review	Text comprehension	43 C
	Interpret an idiomatic phrase used in a movie review	Writer's craft	41 A
	Synthesise a movie review to identify its tone	Writer's craft	44 D
	Analyse a paragraph in a factual text to state its main idea	Text comprehension	29 B
	Infer textual features of an advertising trailer for a movie	Writer's craft	45 D
	Identify a verb in a movie review	Syntax	42 A
	Explain the meaning of a metaphor used in a factual text	Writer's craft	25 D
	Identify an adjective in a narrative	Syntax	34 B
	Interpret the meaning of a simile used in a narrative	Writer's craft	31 C
	Identify specific information in a factual text	Text comprehension	27 C
	Identify the meaning of a word in a poem: mope	Vocabulary	18 A
	Identify the reason for including a particular line in a poem	Text comprehension	20 D
	Identify the meaning of a word in a factual text: expertise	Vocabulary	24 B
	Interpret information in an information text	Text comprehension	13 C
Easy Questions	Identify a pronoun reference in a factual text	Syntax	23 A
	Analyse a narrative to draw a conclusion about the events	Text comprehension	36 D
	Recognise the purpose of capital letters in a narrative	Syntax	6 B
	Analyse a narrative to best describe a character	Text comprehension	38 A
	Locate specific information in an information text	Text comprehension	11 A
	Interpret a character's actions in a narrative	Text comprehension	37 B
	Analyse a narrative to draw a conclusion about the events	Text comprehension	8 B
	Identify alliteration in a narrative	Writer's craft	4 C
	Locate specific information in a narrative	Text comprehension	33 C
	Interpret the meaning of a word in a narrative: beamed	Vocabulary	5 D
	Make an inference from information in a factual text	Text comprehension	28 A
	Synthesise the first three stanzas in a poem to identify their purpose	Text comprehension	17 B
	Identify the main idea in the first paragraph of an information text	Writer's craft	10 B
	Infer the motive for a character's action in a narrative	Text comprehension	32 A
	Interpret a character's feelings from their actions in a narrative	Text comprehension	35 C
	Infer the meaning of a phrase in a poem	Text comprehension	16 C
	Identify a synonym for a word in a narrative: born	Vocabulary	7 C
	Interpret the poet's intention in the last stanza of a poem	Text comprehension	21 B
	Explain the purpose of capital letters in a narrative	Writer's craft	30 A
	Interpret the use of the word 'purrs' to describe sound in a poem	Text comprehension	19 C
	Match information to a diagram in a factual text	Text comprehension	26 A
	Interpret a character's actions in a narrative	Text comprehension	2 B
	Infer a character's feelings throughout a narrative	Text comprehension	3 A
	Infer the reason for a particular layout of part of a poem	Writer's craft	22 A